

a garage at home and had to park her car on the street. She started parking her vehicle far away from her apartment and sometimes had to walk over a mile to her home so that the reposessor wouldn't be able to find her Camry.

One Saturday, Jessica received a call from the local grocery store telling her that she had won a shopping spree. They told her to come right away and look for the man with the red jacket who would be holding a parking space for her. She was to park her car there and enter the store, where she would have thirty minutes to get all the groceries she could for free. Jessica was ecstatic. She took her car away from its hiding place and raced to the store. Just like they had said, there was a man with a red jacket holding a parking space for her. Her encouraged her to run into the store and start her shopping spree.

Jessica began to pull items off the shelves until her cart was overflowing. After her thirty minutes were up she went to the cashier and exclaimed that she was the winner! The cashier asked with a perplexed look, "Winner of what?" Jessica then had a panic attack as she realized what happened. She ran outside to the parking lot to find her Camry was gone. Repossession can be a very creative profession.

Jessica should have known that 100 percent financing is to be avoided. You start out with a problem because you owe more than the car is worth. This situation is what is referred to as buying "upside down." It will end up costing you money to get rid of the car. Jessica discovered this unpleasant fact when she tried to sell the car to get rid of her obligation. She found that she couldn't sell her vehicle for the amount she owed. She didn't have the money to pay the difference so this wasn't an option for her.

Ironically, after her car was repossessed, Jessica received a bill in the mail. This bill was for the deficiency balance. The lender was billing her for the difference between what the car was worth and what she still owed. Remember that a car is a

